



UCC STUDIOS

CONVEF-RGENCE

BRAND NEW DAY



The Blue Page | Editorial

It Is Not A Brand New Day

KEERTI JOSHI

EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

AS MUCH AS WE'D LIKE TO BELIEVE THE world is progressing, we've failed to grow on many issues as a community and a society. I am referring to the Cornell 7, a group of 7 Cornell students who received minimal punishments for sexual assault, and more broadly, the persistent inaction on issues related to the safety of women. Regardless of the legal battle, this issue exists all over the world: in university campuses, in the workplace and more. As a community of young men, it may seem unclear why the issue is relevant to our lives at UCC, but that's a gross misconception. After all, UCC exists to prepare us for the future, when we will become university students, workers, and productive members of society.

Yet, it's difficult for young men to understand these issues and find ways to respond. This is understandable; hearing statistics like 1 in 200 men will have committed an act of sexual assault or worse can be challenging. It is challenging to consider our responsibility in responding to the crimes of other men. It may feel nice to say "not all men" to create distance from these issues. However, those feelings do not excuse refusing to acknowledge victims' concerns and work towards change.

As a community, we must act to prevent this issue from continuing. First, we must eradicate the belief that being a "good" man is simply refraining from committing these heinous crimes. Not committing crimes is not praiseworthy, it is merely the bare minimum to live in a functioning society.

Letting these actions happen when we have the capability to help is unacceptable. It may be difficult, but that is no excuse for failing to act. Frankly, even if it carries social consequences or danger, it's essential to act. Men have privilege and power arise from a variety of factors. Differences in physical strength, social hierarchies, and institutional power all contribute to persistent inequality. As a result, men ought to leverage these advantages, recognizing the particular role they can play in addressing this issue. This is the message we ought to promote at UCC: not through virtue signaling but by taking actual steps that change our world.

We must teach the students in our community what real advocacy, real solidarity and real action look like. Be it increasing our awareness of these through assemblies or increasing the workshops on what consent looks like to include how to act as a third party, actionable steps need to happen.

I do not have all the answers. I have not done enough to combat these issues but I implore us to reflect on what we can do to change our society's culture, not just UCC's. Only then can we even begin to become a "good" man.

Being male does not mean we are guilty for another's actions or deserve to be hated. There is a difference between aiming to address issues or acknowledging that our inaction can contribute to the culture that allows these issues to remain invisible, and allowing people to claim we are evil. These distinctions do matter, but they do not excuse inaction from when the moment calls for it.

Throughout history, women have been forced to deal with these issues alone. Our obligation is to help through listening, questioning our assumptions and raising awareness. Not because we are men, but because we are humans. All humans are deserving of safety and respect.

Let us know about your thoughts via a letter to the editor by scanning the QR Code below.



NEW YEAR, NEW PEOPLE, NEW SPIRIT

FERRARI ZHANG

EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

AS THE NEW SCHOOL YEAR BEGINS, a new Board of Stewards takes the helm. *Convergence* interviewed all ten new Heads of House in a quick-fire format to get to know them better.

Daniil Vetcherebine, Scadding's



What is your single favourite thing about UCC?

Has to be Scadding's in its entirety. We have the best house, the best spirit out of all of the houses, an amazing alumni group, and a fantastic tight knit group of guys, who only want to help each other out. I live and breathe teal for days...

What house activities do you want to add or bring back to the calendar?

Bring back house hockey, it was the most fun we had. I remember Year 8, when we won it, and it was electric.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

We will win this year and go back to back. We set the tone last year and are going to keep the trophy where it belongs, our group of boys hate to lose, our teachers keep us accountable, and Mr. Celebre keeps us at the top of our game.

FERRARI ZHANG - EDITOR-IN-CHIEF
KEERTI JOSHI - EDITOR-IN-CHIEF
DYAUS PAN - MANAGING EDITOR
MATHIS LEVESON - MANAGING EDITOR

Will Chandra, Howard's



What is a hot take you have about a mundane thing?

I don't know if it's a hot take, but Howard's is winning the Prefect's Cup...

What lasting impact do you hope to leave in your house that lasts beyond the end of your term?

I want to ensure that Howard's house members are the most proud and energetic house members in the halls. That starts with ensuring that we bring energy with the house chant, and ultimately that starts with me.

For you, what should the ideal Head of House be like?

I think the ideal head of house is approachable, down to earth, but also has a lot of energy and spirit. The perfect head of house shows up no matter what the event, with a smile on his face.

What is the initiative you are most excited about to bring to your house or to school in general?

ALEXANDER ZHANG - SENIOR EDITOR
WILLIAM ZHOU - SENIOR EDITOR
IBRAHIM CHAUDHRY - JUNIOR EDITOR
JACK DEUDNEY - JUNIOR EDITOR

I'm really excited for the house Year Rep system to take shape. It will give an opportunity for younger students to participate in house leadership, which is really important to prepare the future of the house.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

Because in Howard's we have the best brotherhood—a Ho-Brotherhood—that can't be beat!

Roger Zhu, Seaton's



What is something interesting to know about you?

I am a person who cannot live without classical music every day. My passion for music is so deeply rooted in my heart that this is part of my whole soul and heart. I hope that I can spread my love for classical music to all around me.

What lasting impact do you hope to leave in your house that lasts beyond the end of your term?

ANDRE CANTO CUBAS - BLUE PAGE EDITOR
DANIEL ALORNOZ - SOCIAL MEDIA HEAD
MATHIS LEVESON - COVER DESIGNER
MR. JOHN HOARE - FACULTY ADVISER

NEW YEAR, NEW PEOPLE, NEW SPIRIT

I hope that by the end of my role and departing the college and after a few years, there will still be people who remember what I have done for them personally, what I have tried to improve for the house, and what my personal aspirations are. I hope I will be remembered because of my warmth and care for my house, and all of my genuine conversations that marked my attempt to bridge the gap with everybody.

For you, what should the ideal Head of House be like?

Should be the kind that always prioritizes my house's input. As a head of house I am the representative of the voices of my housemates, and it is my duty and responsibility to respect and present these voices as my priority.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup and the Rao Cup?

In Seaton's, we dominated the Rao Cup last year. This year with Rao Cup soccer 3-2 win, we hope to defend the title for the house. The Prefect's Cup is something that we've aspired to win for a long time. Because of our boarding house's tight bond and familiar connections with everyone, our house spirit is always united, and we can bring out the best of ourselves to win this Cup.



JJ Feehely, Mowbray's



What is a hot take you have about a mundane thing?

Doing the dishes isn't even bad if you got a nice TV show playing.

What lasting impact do you hope to leave in your house that lasts beyond the end of your term?

To be honest, it is for everyone in the house to feel proud to be a Mowman. I'm done with the chirps about the worst locker room, worst house colour etc. These tiny insults don't mean anything because we know how amazing this house truly is, and I want to make sure that every Mowman feels that same pride that myself and the rest of the current house feels.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

For Mowbrays, it is not a question of why, it is a question of when. The whole school knows it's coming. Mowbray's has been rising in the standings each year. The Prefect's Cup is almost ready to come home, and I will share with you exactly how it will come home. It won't be with a bunch of first places in house events or one dominant soccer player. It will be all about consistency. We will never default and we will always have guys ready to play. We will consistently get Top 4 in every house event and that will be all we need to claim the Prefect's Cup as our own.

Jeffrey Carrique, Orr's



What is your single favourite thing about UCC ?

My favourite thing about UCC is probably the feeling of a "second home". I spend more time during the day at UCC than anywhere else. I have been here for pretty much my entire life, the college is just part of my day to day routine, and it feels like home.

What lasting impact do you hope to leave in your house that lasts beyond the end of your term?

Obviously the goal is to win the prefects cup. That goal will never change. Beyond that, I really have been big on trying to make this the best year possible within Orr's. I want to create a brotherhood inside of the house that will create memories for years to come. I want this to be a year so memorable that in 50 years we will have an Orr's 2026-27 reunion.

How will you strengthen house spirit?

My efforts will not only be in school, but out of school: Orr's will have events outside of school as well.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

I think it's pretty simple. All houses have around 95-100 students and on paper, all houses are typically equal.

NEW YEAR, NEW PEOPLE, NEW SPIRIT

This year, the air is different in Orr's house. The level of commitment, the dial in from the Orrsmen is different this year. Sort of reminds me of the feeling in the air from the 2023 group (Prefect's Cup champs). From the Y8s to the Y12s, the boys are ready to show up, compete, and bring the cup back where it belongs.

Good luck to the other houses, Orr's.

Duncan MacLeod, Jackson's



What is a hot take you have about a mundane thing?

Olive oil can go with any food and make it taste delicious. If you throw olive oil and salt with any type of food, I'll eat it.

What is your single favourite thing about UCC?

My favourite thing about UCC is the lacrosse team, our culture and our coaches. I'm looking forward to practice during the year with the guys, and building off of our CISAA championship last season.

What house activities do you want to add or bring back to the calendar?

House golf would be awesome. We could definitely set up a short hole on Lord's Field for house golf. I know myself and most

other guys in the house would be ready to play in a heartbeat.

For you, what should the ideal Head of House be like?

Someone who maintains balance throughout the year: able to meet their own needs while also still being there for the house.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

We have the best shot out of any house at the college: best athletes, best mindset and best team dynamics. No doubt in my mind we'll win the Prefect's Cup.

Ryker Babcock, Wedd's



What is a hot take you have about a mundane thing?

We should be allowed to wear white socks. I don't really know why we can't, but I think it looks just as professional as other colours.

What house activities do you want to add or bring back to the calendar?

I want to have more things that everyone can actually get involved in. I'd like to bring back Sunday meetings where everyone can just share something about their week. I also think a weekly pickup basketball game could be really fun. I'd want to send out a house survey too,

so people can actually have a say in what we do. Some other things I'd like to possibly add are a Christmas scavenger hunt and Root Beer Mile. Also, since we live at school, I want Wedd's to show up to other UCC teams' games and celebrate people when they accomplish something.

For you, what should the ideal Head of House be like?

I think a good HOH needs to be accountable, present, and someone people can look up to. You can't tell people to show up and bring energy if you aren't doing it yourself. I think the HOH should set the example, not complain, and be someone who lifts people up when they're having a bad day.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup and the Rao Cup?

BBB — Boarding Brotherhood Bond. I think Wedd's has a really good group of people, and if everyone actually shows up for each other, we have a chance to win both. It's not going to be one person carrying the house. Everyone has to contribute, whether that's a competition, a house event, or just supporting someone else. If we have that brotherhood all year, I think the results will follow.



NEW YEAR, NEW PEOPLE, NEW SPIRIT

Thomas Langlois, Martland's



What is a hot take you have about a mundane thing?

Purple is the best colour by a landslide.

What is something interesting to know about you?

I like to make music in my spare time.

What lasting impact do you hope to leave in your house that lasts beyond the end of your term?

I hope that the members of my house look back on this year with pride. (I also hope they have as much fun as possible)

For you, what should the ideal Head of House be like?

The ideal Head of House should be someone who is always there for younger students, always offering a helping hand and supporting them.

What is the initiative you are most excited about to bring to your house or to school in general?

I am most excited about starting an electronic music club.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

Our house will win this year because we care.

Joe Kedwell, McHugh's



What is your single favourite thing about UCC?

I would say it is a good lunch period, with all the boys at the table chopping it up having a laugh, nothing can quite top that experience.

What lasting impact do you hope to leave in your house that lasts beyond the end of your term?

100% house snack success rate.

What house activities do you want to add or bring back to the calendar?

I think the idea of adding a house flag football intramural event would be great, intramurals is something we all love, and football is one of the most beloved sports at the college. Yet many lack the opportunity to play without wanting to sacrifice hours upon hours of time and playing such a physical sport, so a little fun house competition, flag football or touch football event would be great in my opinion, and loved by many.

For you, what should the ideal Head of House be like?

Always present, wanting to be there and truly cares about participation and the success of the house, approachable, always has snacks, and someone that anyone in the house can come talk to.

Dylan Strashin, Bremner's



What is a hot take you have about a mundane thing?

Fall is better than summer.

What house activities do you want to add or bring back to the calendar?

House flag football. I think people love playing football and would love house football. I know this because I could tell how well received it was as a one off last year.

What is the initiative you are most excited about to bring to your house or to school in general?

The initiative I'm the most excited to bring to Bremner's is what I call 'The Bremocracy'. This is a grade rep system where I appoint a rep at each grade level. We will meet weekly to discuss the ideas of their peers.

Why will your house win the Prefect's Cup?

I think we're going to win the Prefect's Cup due to the electric culture we have in Bremner's this year. There is a genuine desire for the house to succeed. Plus, we have the most Dawgz.

Special thanks to Ryan She for providing photos from his albums.

A BRAVE NEW WORLD: THE US-CANADA TRADE WAR

ANDRE CANTO CUBAS & JACK DEUDNEY

BLUE PAGE EDITOR & JUNIOR EDITOR



Juno Beach, D-Day 1944

FREEZING WINDS HOWL as seasick soldiers are swayed by rough waters. A thud rings out as the ship's door drops onto the sandbar where waves crash. Lead strikes flesh like hail, whizzing by deafeningly. Crawling under heavy fire, men are stricken with terror surrounded by fallen friends, strewn about lifeless. Others huddle behind tank traps, sprayed by blood-slicked seawater. Yet they continue with grim determination. That day, side-by-side, Canadians and Americans fought on the beaches of Normandy to liberate the world from Axis evil.

For the next 80 years the US and Canada became closely intertwined. NORAD, NATO, and NAFTA created military, security, and economic ties. It was one of the most mutually beneficial alliances in the world.

It has only taken 2 years to fracture the brotherly, almost symbiotic connection the two countries have. Since his election as President in 2024, Donald Trump's administration began threatening Canada with on and off tariffs. A deal had been struck to reduce tensions by both countries, but at the finish line

the Trump administration changed parts of the deal. First, Canada would require US supervision for any other trade agreement with countries. Second, Canadian trade policy would be forced to align with the US on tariffs. Next, US Tariffs would only be reduced from 50% to 25% on key industries. In addition, tariffs would remain on pickup trucks, putting the jobs of 20,000 workers at GM and Ford auto plants at risk due to high costs. The last two major issues that caused Canada to reject the deal were cultural. The Americans demanded no obligation for US companies to follow Canadian bilingual packaging rules, and the removal of mandates for streaming platforms like Netflix, which would have been an outrage to Quebec.

Prime Minister Mark Carney and the ministers viewed these changes as being unacceptable to their aims of trade diversification. In the following days, Trump himself tried to convince Canada to complete the deal by renaming

Lake Ontario to Lake America. Unsurprisingly, this didn't convince Canadians and instead strengthened their resolve. The Trump administration's sabre-rattling failed, and on the fateful day of the 8th of September tariffs went into effect for billions worth of goods. Many things have happened in the short time since then. Canada has made a rapid shift to the EU, even being promised a spot as an associate member, a still undefined status. Canada has been thrown into the wilderness, no longer solely protected by the might of the US.

Recent weeks have marked a change that hasn't been seen since the fall of the Pre-WW2 world order. The main sentiment among Canadians is anger against the US for a pointless trade war. Yet, more important is the fear due to uncertainty over what will happen. A hope for stability that has fueled the best polling numbers for the Liberals since before the moon landing. On the 10th of September,



A Panoramic View of Lake Ontario

A BRAVE NEW WORLD: THE US-CANADA TRADE WAR

Carney reached the highest approval rating ever recorded, 70%, for a Prime Minister in history of Canada.

There are many ramifications from the collapse of trade talks. President of the European Commission Ursula von der Leyen created the idea of associate membership at the annual EU state of the union address. PM Carney has outlined ideas for how Canada could participate, speaking in front of the European Parliament on September 17 to accept the proposal. One of the ideas swirling around is that Europe and Canada would work together on securing the Arctic, and providing minerals and gas that Europe has been in deep need of since the start of the war in Ukraine. Plans are also moving ahead to jointly invest in research for AI and other sciences, such as on Sept 20, 2026 when PM Carney and French President Macron met. On St. Pierre and Miquelon, a French territory off the coast of Newfoundland, the two vowed for stronger France-Canada relations and shared space launching infrastructure.

So far, little sovereignty is being given to the EU, and Canada will improve the CETA (Canada-EU Trade Agreement) to follow EU regulations better. The details of



Mark Carney with Emmanuel Macron (right)

what associate membership will mean for Canada will be finalized during the Montreal EU-Canada summit from October 29-30, 2026.

The future of CUSMA is to be seen, as the US hasn't indicated a willingness to extend the deal, which could damage Canada's GDP growth in the future if it falls apart. It has entered its sunset clause, but will remain until at least 2036, although US tariffs have been weakening the strength of the agreement.

In response to the trade war, Canada has cooperated with countries, including members of the aforementioned EU. Trade with East Asian countries, especially China, has skyrocketed, with 30.1% of all Canadian trade being with China. Canadian trade has increased in all markets except the US, with record level trade in Latin America, the Caribbean, Europe and Africa. Consumers are taking part too with many refusing to buy American made products, amplifying existing governmental initiatives.

Costs will go up as tariffs are ultimately a tax on the consumer. For instance, electronic products are facing a tariff of 50%. With American electronics making up roughly 15-20% of Canadian electronic supplies, costs will increase until Canada

is able to supplement these purchases with other trade partners.

Many large grocery chains are mislabelling products as Canadian, by using patriotic imagery like maple leaves and flags. This has become a widely reported issue as the mislabelling has made consumers mistakenly buy American (or other foreign) products instead of Canadian. The government still needs to regulate mislabelling to more strongly discourage it.

Provincial governments have placed restrictions on US trips by Canadian schools in response. The reasons stated for this have been due to "complex sociopolitical" problems between the countries. The unfortunate consequence is that it will lead to less opportunities for students to go abroad for music competitions or similar activities. The upside is that it will lead to more participation in Canadian alternatives for students. Ramifications will also be seen throughout the Upper Canada College community, as tighter restrictions on border crossings will make it significantly more challenging for foreign born UCC students to go on trips to the US.

Ultimately, the trade war has caused a shift in Canadian economic policy, forcing Canada to become less reliant on its historical main trade partner, the US. Although the current geopolitical situation presents challenges, diversification of trade promises a less volatile economy. But there remains uncertainty, with current issues swaying the economic ship of Canada as we head towards an unknown future and a new world—one potentially unrecognizable to that of now.



Ursula Von Der Leyen (above)

A NEW CHAPTER FOR CANADIAN SOCCER

DYAUS PAN

MANAGING EDITOR

Note: This article was completed on September 25th. Hence, certain results and speculations discussed have already happened since the publication of this issue of Convergence.

AT 9:09PM ON JULY 2ND, the final whistle blew for the Portugal vs. Croatia Round of 32 match at Toronto Stadium (BMO Field) to conclude Canada's tenure as co-host of the 2026 FIFA World Cup. Two days later, the Canadian Men's National Team's Cinderella story came to a humbling end at the hands of a 3-0 defeat to Morocco in the Round of 16.

Despite this, fans rejoiced in Canada's newfound sporting success. In just 12 years, Canada progressed from an all-time low 122nd FIFA ranking to Stephen Eustáquio's 90+2' winning goal against South Africa in the Round of 32—a moment that sent a frisson of joy into the hearts of Canadians around the world. Canada soccer has left behind the dark days of irrelevance, establishing a culture that demands excellence from players and investment from our institutions. Unsurprisingly, this culture has only further advanced in just the few months following the World Cup. Today, soccer in Canada is at its peak, but it has yet to reach its absolute zenith.

Players and Club Soccer

Representing one's country on the international stage is the greatest honour, but club soccer is where these players truly make their marks. Since the World Cup, many Canadian players have made huge moves to top European leagues. Not only have they transferred to bigger stages, but they've flourished too.



Jonathan David

Jonathan David's World Cup campaign can best be described as inconsistent. After an abysmal game against Bosnia to start the tournament, David silenced all the haters with a hat-trick against Qatar in Canada's 6-0 win. However, just as quickly as David ascended, his form quickly fell as he failed to contribute anything meaningful in the next three games. Following the World Cup, pundits consistently doubted his capability to perform in Europe's top leagues. At Juventus from 2025-2026, he made 46 appearances, yet scored only eight goals for the Italian giants. A move was imminent, and it soon came in the form of a loan to Atlético Madrid. In three matches, he has an assist and three goals, including the winning goal in a 2-1 win against Real Madrid. David appears to have left his poor form behind, as he looks to continue his excellent performance for club and country.

Cyle Larin's name will forever be etched in Canadian history. His spectacular volley against Bosnia awarded Canada its first ever World Cup point. Unsurprisingly, Larin is more than just a Canadian fan favourite; he has recently emerged as a superstar. The "Brampton Bagsman" has scored 7 goals in 8 appearances for Southampton in the Championship as well as a League Cup goal, meriting the Championship's August Player of the Month award. At one moment, he was the highest

scoring player across England's top four divisions. At 31 years old, Larin looks to help Southampton reach promotion to the English Premier League despite a four point deduction following their "Spygate" controversy last season.

Arguably the most significant Canadian move following the World Cup, Promise David has left Union Saint-Gilloise to Brighton & Hove Albion on a season-long loan with an obligation to buy. The 25 year old had 41 goals and 9 assists in 82 appearances for Union SG, demonstrating remarkable ability that earned him a shot at the top flight of English soccer. He has made two Premier League appearances, but has yet to mark a contribution on the score sheet. A young and physical striker, David has much promise ahead of him in this next chapter.

Some other significant player news items include Stephen Eustáquio's move from Porto to Swansea, Niko Sigur's transfer from Hajduk Split to Toulouse in Ligue 1, and World Cup breakout midfielder Nathan Saliba's transfer to Villarreal. A product of CF Montreal, Saliba joined fellow Canadians Tani Oluwaseyi and Tajon Buchanan at the Spanish club.

Injuries and Recovery

Captain Alphonso Davies was limited during the World Cup, playing only roughly 16 minutes in a substitute appearance against South Africa. He has since recovered, playing regular minutes for Bayern Munich, including starting and assisting Jamal Musiala's opening goal in their 7-0 rout of Union Berlin. Unfortunately, that is the only good news regarding the health of the men's

A NEW CHAPTER FOR CANADIAN SOCCER

national team. Ismaël Koné continues to recover from a reckless challenge by Qatar's Assim Madibo that fractured his tibia and fibula; he hopefully looks to return to action with Sassuolo in Serie A around October to November. Similarly, Koné's teammate and close friend Moïse Bombito, who returned from a left tibia fracture just in time for the World Cup, has undergone another surgery following the return of pain. The OGC Nice centre-back's return timeline is unknown. Furthermore, Bombito's centreback partner recently dislocated his hip during a training session with Marseille. He is set to miss three months.

Another significant injury challenge includes Alistair Johnston's hamstring injury, which thwarted a transfer to Premier League club Everton. He looks to return in October, although he has now passed the transfer deadline to make a move from Scottish giants Celtic to a more prestigious league. Lastly, wingers Marcelo Flores and Ali Ahmed both are recovering from ACL tears. In summary, Canada is riddled with health issues, all of which will hopefully lead to successful recoveries in due time.

Economics and Infrastructure

Prior to the World Cup, FIFA commissioned Deloitte Canada to project the estimated impact of the tournament for the country. Deloitte projected up to \$3.8 billion in economic output, \$2 billion added to the national GDP and \$1.9 billion in tournament-related capital. The accuracy of this projection is unknown, but it is safe to say that the World Cup brought various benefits to Canada's economy. Toronto hosted six matches and recorded approximately 250,000 spectators at Toronto Stadium (BMO Field). More

than 350,000 people attended the 23-day Toronto Fan Festival and another 60,600 at public match broadcasts at Nathan Phillips Square, excluding the World Cup Final. BMO Field received \$146 million in upgrades from player facilities to 17,000 temporary seats. However, this all came at a cost. Toronto's total direct World Cup hosting budget reached \$380 million, well above the estimated \$300 million prior to the tournament. Meanwhile, Vancouver's estimated hosting cost was \$114 million, much lower than their previous estimate of \$145 million. In similar fashion, Vancouver saw many infrastructure improvements at BC Place as well as boosts across local businesses.

As for the future of youth infrastructure, the federal government has committed \$2.165 billion toward a Canadian Tire Jumpstart project intended to build 25 community soccer pitches across Canada by 2029. Additionally, the government is also providing up to \$9.826 million for planning, design, and pre-construction of a future Canada Soccer National Training Centre, although this is not the construction cost of the completed centre. BC has also led a separate Mini Peaks Legacy Program, with the provincial government, viaSport, and the Vancouver Whitecaps combining for \$13 million dollars to build 20 mini-pitches across the province. The World Cup showed that the future of Canadian soccer is bright. Now, with federal, provincial, and local governments supporting critical infrastructure to advance youth development, the young stars of tomorrow will be provided with the support to perform at the highest level in the world.

National Team Fixtures

The men's national team looks ahead to their "homecoming" friendlies against Chile, Peru, and the United States.

This is a great chance for young talent to emerge in the absence of many injured players. Next is the CONCACAF Nations League, with a two-leg tie scheduled during the November 9-17 international window, and the 2027 Gold Cup (qualification is tied to Nations League performance). There is much competition ahead prior to the 2030 World Cup, and it all starts soon.

For the first time since 2007, Canada's men's U-20s qualified for the 2027 FIFA U-20 World Cup in Azerbaijan and Uzbekistan by beating Jamaica 3-1 in extra time in the CONCACAF U-20 quarter finals. Canada then lost 2-1 to Mexico in the semifinal, narrowly missing qualification for the Olympic men's tournament.

Lastly, the women's U-20 team made an impressive deep run in the 2026 FIFA Women's U-20 World Cup in Poland. After a group stage that included a 1-1 draw against England, they upset France 3-1 in the Round of 16. Unfortunately, the magic would run out as they fell 2-0 to North Korea. Nonetheless, both the women's and men's U-20 teams have shown that Canada's youth development pipeline is strong. With new investment and infrastructure, it will only continue to get stronger.

Conclusion

Some look upon Canada's World Cup as an incredible milestone. Some view it as the highest our nation can reach; Canada Soccer vehemently disagrees. As children play on new soccer fields across the country and programs receive new funding, it is only a matter of time before we shock the world once more. World Cup 2030 may seem far away, but there are many steps leading up to it. Until then, everything is just preparation... hopefully alongside a few trophies.